

Soon, Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (more commonly known as DARPA) decided to take an interest in this. This is the same DARPA that is known for inventing the earliest form of the Internet as well as modern day GPS. They decided to try to create a voice assistant that would assist soldiers in real-time.

Siri begins : The origin story

Siri was founded in 2007, but the research it was based on came from a DARPA programme that started way back in 2003. They called it Cognitive Assistant that Learns and Organizes (CALO). Acronyms have an odd habit of being derived from the coolest of origin languages, and CALO isn't one to break away from said habit. Derived from the Latin word 'calonis' or Soldier's Assistant, CALO was the foundation on which present-day Siri is built.

The story of Apple's acquisition of Siri is in keeping with the rather covert nature of things up until then. In February 2010, about 3 weeks after it first appeared on the iTunes store, Dag Kittaus (Co-founder of Siri) got a phone call from a mystery number asking to meet – it was Steve Jobs. In a later interview, he is quoted as saying, "Of course it was a great moment when Steve Jobs called and wanted to buy my company. It was surreal. When I heard that it was him, I knew we had made it big. In advance, we were pretty confident that the technology we had developed was so startling that we would get some kind of breakthrough. Steve was the first caller."

Rather strangely, a lot of what made Siri such an exciting purchase for Apple wasn't implemented immediately. Apple released a beta in October 2011 that was fully integrated with the



HAL 9000 - the philosophical progenitor of all modern day AIs. Also the face of evil computers until the bad guys in Terminator took over



The original Siri. Debuting in 2010, it took just 3 weeks for it to attract Steve Job's attention.